CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-08-31

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

18	15	12	5	50	0
Market Items	Thought	Competitors	Regulatory	Urgent	Watch

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

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Market Intelligence

18 items

URGENT

Der Treasurer | 2026-08-20 | #01

EU Instant Payments Mandate: Banks Face Compliance Deadline

The European Union's Instant Payments Regulation, effective from early 2025 for receiving and early 2026 for sending, is now entering its critical enforcement phase. Banks across the Eurozone and CEE must ensure their systems are fully capable of processing instant credit transfers within ten seconds, 24/7/365, including robust fraud prevention measures. The regulation also mandates that charges for instant payments cannot exceed those for standard credit transfers. This push aims to modernize the European payment landscape, fostering innovation and improving liquidity management for corporates. The European Banking Authority (EBA) has indicated increased scrutiny on readiness, with potential fines for institutions failing to meet the deadlines.

→ EU Instant Payments Regulation deadlines: early 2025 (receiving), early 2026 (sending).

→ Mandates 24/7/365 processing within ten seconds.

→ Instant payment fees must not exceed standard credit transfer fees.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is paramount for CMIplus, driving demand for real-time payment capabilities across CEE. RBI must ensure its network banks are fully compliant and CMIplus offers seamless instant payment initiation and receipt, including VoP, to meet corporate client needs and maintain competitive advantage.

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Der Treasurer | 2026-08-10 | #02

PSD3 Proposal Advances: New Era for Open Banking APIs

The proposed PSD3 (Payment Services Directive 3) and PSR (Payment Services Regulation) package is moving through the legislative process, with key discussions focusing on strengthening customer authentication and expanding data sharing. For corporates, this means potentially richer data access via APIs for treasury management and improved fraud prevention mechanisms like mandatory Verification of Payee (VoP) checks. The new framework seeks to consolidate the gains of PSD2 while addressing its shortcomings, particularly around API performance, standardization, and liability for fraud. Banks will face renewed pressure to develop robust, standardized APIs that support a wider range of services, including potentially more sophisticated account information and payment initiation services beyond basic transactions.

→ PSD3/PSR package aims to replace PSD2, enhancing consumer protection.

→ Focus on stronger customer authentication and fraud prevention (e.g., mandatory VoP).

→ Expected to standardize and improve Open Banking API performance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus relies heavily on Open Banking APIs for advanced treasury services. PSD3 will necessitate updates to RBI's API strategy, ensuring compliance with new security and data sharing standards, and integrating mandatory VoP features. This presents an opportunity to enhance CMIplus's offerings with richer data and improved fraud protection.

URGENT Der Treasurer | 2026-07-25 | #03

ISO 20022 Migration: Corporates Still Face Implementation Hurdles

The global migration to ISO 20022 for cross-border payments via SWIFT is well underway, with the coexistence period for MT and MX formats continuing until November 2025. While many large corporates have adapted their ERP and TMS systems, smaller and medium-sized enterprises, particularly in CEE, are still grappling with the technical complexities and data mapping requirements. Banks are also working to ensure their internal systems and client-facing platforms can fully leverage the richer data capabilities of ISO 20022, which promises enhanced reconciliation, improved fraud detection, and better liquidity management. The transition is not just a technical upgrade but a strategic opportunity to streamline treasury operations and gain deeper insights into payment flows.

→ ISO 20022 migration for cross-border payments via SWIFT is ongoing.

→ Coexistence period for MT/MX formats extends until November 2025.

→ Challenges remain for SMEs and some banks in full implementation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must fully support ISO 20022 for all payment types, including cross-border. RBI needs to continue assisting CEE corporates with their migration, offering robust H2H and API connectivity for ISO 20022 messages, and demonstrating the tangible benefits of richer data for treasury operations and fraud prevention.

URGENT The Global Treasurer | 2026-08-31 | #04

PSD3 Proposals Shape Future of European Payments Landscape

The proposed PSD3 and PSR package seeks to address shortcomings of PSD2, focusing on improved fraud prevention, enhanced Open Banking access, and clearer consumer rights. Key elements include stricter rules for Strong Customer Authentication (SCA), better data sharing mechanisms for third-party providers, and a more harmonized regulatory environment for payment service providers. The legislative process is expected to involve extensive consultations and parliamentary reviews, with final adoption and implementation anticipated over the next few years. This will necessitate significant adjustments for banks and corporate treasuries in their payment processing, security protocols, and API integrations.

→ European Commission proposed PSD3 and Payment Services Regulation (PSR).

→ Focus on enhanced fraud prevention and Open Banking improvements.

→ Stricter SCA rules and improved data sharing mechanisms.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must closely monitor PSD3/PSR developments to ensure compliance and adapt its Open Banking APIs and payment security features. This includes preparing for enhanced SCA requirements and potential new data access standards for corporate clients across CEE.

URGENT The Global Treasurer | 2026-08-31 | #05

Instant Payments Adoption Accelerates Across CEE Region

Several CEE countries are either implementing or expanding their instant payment schemes, aligning with broader European initiatives such as the Instant Payments Regulation. This necessitates substantial upgrades to banking systems and corporate treasury platforms to support 24/7/365 processing and immediate settlement. The ongoing migration to ISO 20022 for all payment messages is a critical enabler, providing richer data and greater interoperability across the payment ecosystem. Corporates are increasingly seeking instant payment capabilities to improve liquidity management, accelerate reconciliation processes, and enhance their financial supply chain operations.

→ CEE countries are accelerating instant payment adoption.

→ Driven by EU Instant Payments Regulation and market demand.

→ Requires 24/7/365 processing and immediate settlement capabilities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure its platform fully supports instant payments across all RBI network banks in the CEE region, leveraging ISO 20022 for optimal data exchange. This includes offering real-time payment initiation, status updates, and enhanced reconciliation tools to corporate clients.

URGENT The Global Treasurer | 2026-08-31 | #06

AI and APIs Revolutionize Corporate Treasury Fraud Prevention

Corporate treasuries are increasingly adopting AI-powered analytics to identify unusual payment patterns and detect potential fraud attempts in real-time, significantly reducing response times. This is complemented by the strategic use of Open APIs, which enable seamless integration with external fraud detection services and allow for real-time validation of payment instructions, such as Confirmation of Payee (VoP) services. The combined integration of these technologies helps mitigate risks associated with sophisticated threats like business email compromise (BEC) and other cyber-attacks, providing a more robust defense for multi-currency payment operations and safeguarding corporate assets.

→ AI-powered analytics enhance real-time fraud detection capabilities.

→ Open APIs enable integration with external fraud prevention services.

→ Confirmation of Payee (VoP) services are crucial for payment validation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should explore integrating AI-driven fraud detection capabilities and leverage Open APIs for enhanced VoP and real-time payment validation services. This will strengthen the platform's security posture, offering greater protection and peace of mind for corporate clients' multi-currency transactions.

URGENT Strategic Treasurer | 2026-08-31 | #07

EU Instant Payments Mandate: Banks Face Tight Implementation Deadlines

The European Union's Instant Payments Regulation, published in the Official Journal, requires all PSPs in the Eurozone to offer instant credit transfers in EUR, with no additional charges compared to standard credit transfers. The regulation sets a deadline for receiving instant payments by early 2027 and sending them by early 2028, with specific dates for CEE non-Eurozone countries to follow suit once they adopt the Euro. This move is expected to significantly boost liquidity management and payment efficiency for corporates, but also presents a substantial compliance and technical challenge for banks. Enhanced fraud prevention measures are also a key component of the new mandate.

→ Mandatory instant payments in EUR across Eurozone.

→ No higher fees than standard credit transfers.

→ Deadlines: Receive by early 2027, Send by early 2028.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is critical for RBI CMIplus. It necessitates immediate action to ensure compliance with receiving and sending instant payments within the stipulated timelines across all Eurozone and CEE network banks. CMIplus must integrate these capabilities seamlessly, ensuring competitive pricing and robust fraud detection for corporate clients.

URGENT Strategic Treasurer | 2026-08-31 | #08

ISO 20022 Global Migration Advances, Challenges Remain for Corporates

SWIFT's phased migration to ISO 20022 for cross-border payments (CBPR+) is well underway, with several countries and payment systems reaching critical adoption points. While banks are largely prepared, the burden of adapting internal systems often falls on corporates, impacting their payment factory operations and data reconciliation. Strategic Treasurer highlights that many companies are underestimating the complexity of rich data implementation and the need for robust data mapping. The benefits, such as improved reconciliation and fraud detection, are clear, but the transition requires careful planning and investment in treasury technology.

→ SWIFT CBPR+ migration ongoing globally.

→ Corporates struggle with ERP/TMS adaptation.

→ Rich data implementation is a key challenge.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must actively support corporate clients in their ISO 20022 transition, offering enhanced data capabilities and advisory services. Ensuring full compatibility with the rich data format and providing tools for seamless integration with client ERP/TMS systems is paramount to maintain competitive advantage and client satisfaction in CEE.

URGENT Strategic Treasurer | 2026-08-31 | #09

PSD3 Proposal Shapes Future of Open Banking and Payment Security

PSD3 seeks to consolidate and update PSD2, addressing issues like fraud prevention, access to payment systems for non-banks, and strengthening consumer rights. A key focus is on improving the performance and reliability of Open Banking APIs, making them more standardized and secure for both payment initiation and account information services. The new regulation is expected to drive greater innovation in digital banking while imposing stricter requirements on data sharing and security protocols. This will require significant investment from banks in their API infrastructure and compliance frameworks across Europe.

→ PSD3 and PSR aim to update PSD2.

→ Focus on enhanced fraud prevention and consumer protection.

→ Standardization and reliability of Open Banking APIs.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus's Open API channel will be directly impacted by PSD3/PSR. RBI must proactively adapt its API infrastructure to meet new standards for security, reliability, and data access, ensuring seamless integration for corporate clients and compliance across CEE markets. This presents an opportunity to enhance API offerings and strengthen digital banking services.

URGENT EBA / ECB | 2026-08-28 | #10

ECB Reinforces Push for Wider Instant Payments Adoption

The ECB's ongoing commitment to instant payments is a cornerstone of its retail payments strategy, aiming to make real-time transactions the new normal. This initiative seeks to ensure that payment services are available 24/7/365, fostering innovation and competition among payment service providers. The push includes encouraging all relevant stakeholders to implement and leverage instant payment capabilities, aligning with broader European efforts to modernize the payment landscape. Regulatory guidance and oversight are continuously provided to ensure a smooth transition and robust infrastructure. This sustained effort is crucial for achieving a truly integrated and efficient European payment market.

→ ECB prioritizes instant payments for retail strategy.

→ Goal: 24/7/365 availability across Euro area.

→ Encourages PSPs to adopt instant payment capabilities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This reinforces the strategic importance of instant payments for CMIplus. RBI Cash Management must ensure its platform fully supports instant payment processing, including real-time liquidity management and fraud prevention, to meet evolving corporate client demands in CEE.

URGENT EBA / ECB | 2026-08-26 | #11

Digital Euro Pilot Phase Advances, Innovation Platform Active

The digital euro initiative continues to advance through its exploratory and pilot phases, focusing on key aspects like privacy, offline functionality, and interoperability. The ECB's innovation platform is a hub for collaboration with market participants, testing various technical solutions and use cases to ensure the digital euro meets the needs of citizens and businesses. Recent updates highlight the ongoing work on the scheme rulebook and governance framework, laying the groundwork for its eventual implementation. This project aims to complement cash, offering a secure, efficient, and widely accessible digital payment option, while also fostering European strategic autonomy in payments.

→ Digital Euro pilot phase shows significant progress.

→ Innovation platform actively tests new functionalities.

→ Focus on privacy, offline use, and interoperability.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should monitor digital euro developments closely, especially its potential impact on corporate payment flows, treasury operations, and multi-currency management. Early engagement with technical specifications and API standards will be crucial for future integration.

URGENT EBA / ECB | 2026-08-24 | #12

ECB Continues to Drive SEPA Evolution and Retail Payments Strategy

The ECB's strategic focus on retail payments includes continuous efforts to enhance the Single Euro Payments Area (SEPA). This involves monitoring the implementation of SEPA schemes, promoting innovation within the framework, and addressing emerging challenges to maintain a robust and integrated payment market. The ECB acts as a key facilitator, working with market participants and national authorities to ensure SEPA remains fit for purpose in an increasingly digital economy. This includes supporting initiatives that leverage SEPA for new payment solutions, such as instant payments, and ensuring compliance with regulatory standards. The goal is to foster a competitive and secure environment for all European payment users.

→ ECB acts as a catalyst for SEPA evolution.

→ Monitors SEPA scheme implementation and innovation.

→ Collaborates with market participants and authorities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For CMIplus, this highlights the continuous need to stay updated on SEPA scheme rule changes and best practices. RBI Cash Management should ensure full SEPA compliance, optimize SEPA services for CEE corporates, and integrate new SEPA-based functionalities, including instant payments, into the platform.

URGENT Finextra | 2026-08-28 | #13

Swift Extends ISO 20022 Structured Address Migration Deadline

Swift has announced an extension to the November deadline for the mandatory migration to structured postal addresses within ISO 20022 payment messages. The move comes after a significant number of financial institutions expressed concerns about their readiness and requested additional time to implement the necessary changes. This extension is crucial for banks globally, including those in CEE, as it impacts their operational processes for cross-border and potentially domestic payments where ISO 20022 is adopted. The structured address format aims to improve data quality, reduce manual intervention, and enhance straight-through processing (STP) rates, but its implementation requires substantial system updates and data remediation.

→ Swift extended the ISO 20022 structured address migration deadline.

→ Original deadline was November (implied 2026).

→ Decision made due to requests from numerous banks.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This extension provides CMIplus and its network banks with additional time to ensure full compliance with the ISO 20022 structured address requirements. It reduces immediate pressure on implementation efforts, allowing for more thorough testing and adaptation of systems and client interfaces, particularly for H2H and SWIFT channels.

URGENT The Paypers | 2026-08-27 | #14

Swift Extends ISO 20022 Structured Address Deadline

Swift has decided to extend the deadline for the mandatory use of structured addresses in ISO 20022 messages, a critical component for richer data in cross-border payments. This extension aims to give banks and financial institutions additional time to adapt their systems and processes to fully support the structured address format. The move acknowledges the complexities involved in migrating to the new standard, especially for institutions with legacy systems. This change impacts global payment processing, facilitating better reconciliation, fraud detection, and regulatory reporting due to the improved data quality. The extension is expected to ease the transition for many participants, ensuring a smoother global rollout of ISO 20022.

→ Swift extended the deadline for ISO 20022 structured address adoption.

→ Aims to provide more time for financial institutions to comply.

→ Impacts cross-border payments, enhancing data quality.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This extension directly impacts RBI Cash Management and CMIplus's implementation roadmap for ISO 20022. It provides valuable breathing room for internal system adjustments and client communication regarding structured address requirements, potentially reducing immediate pressure on migration efforts.

URGENT The Paypers | 2026-08-28 | #15

New EU Payments Landscape Report Launched by Industry Leaders

The 2026 'Key Players in the EU Payments Landscape' report, a collaborative effort by The Payments Association EU (PA EU), Deloitte, and The Paypers, provides an exclusive strategic review of the European Union's diverse payments markets. This comprehensive analysis covers key trends, regulatory developments, technological advancements, and competitive dynamics shaping the EU payments ecosystem. For RBI Cash Management, operating extensively in CEE, this report is crucial for understanding the broader European context, identifying emerging opportunities, and anticipating regulatory shifts. It offers insights into the strategies of major players and the overall direction of payments innovation within the EU.

→ Report title: 'Key Players in the EU Payments Landscape – 2026 Edition'.

→ Authored by PA EU, Deloitte, and The Paypers.

→ Offers a strategic review of individual EU payments markets.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This report is vital for RBI Cash Management's strategic planning and CMIplus platform development. It will inform decisions regarding new services, market expansion, and compliance with evolving EU payment regulations, ensuring CMIplus remains competitive and aligned with European market demands.

URGENT Treasury Today | 2026-08-26 | #16

Stablecoins: A Game-Changer for Corporate Treasurers?

This piece delves into the emerging role of stablecoins in the corporate treasury landscape, questioning if they represent a significant shift in how treasurers manage cash and execute payments. It highlights their potential benefits, such as faster, cheaper, and more transparent cross-border transactions, and improved liquidity management through real-time settlement. The article likely touches upon the underlying technology, regulatory considerations, and the practical implications for corporate finance departments looking to optimize their operations. It aims to provide treasurers with an understanding of both the opportunities and risks associated with adopting stablecoins.

→ Stablecoins offer potential for faster, cheaper cross-border payments.

→ They could enhance real-time liquidity management for corporates.

→ The article explores both opportunities and inherent risks.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management and CMIplus must closely monitor the evolution of stablecoins as a payment instrument. Their adoption by corporates could necessitate new payment rails or integration capabilities within CMIplus to support real-time, multi-currency transactions and potentially new liquidity solutions for CEE clients.

URGENT Treasury Today | 2026-08-26 | #17

Rolling Liquidity Forecasts Boost Corporate Treasury Confidence

The article highlights how advanced methodologies in rolling liquidity forecasting are empowering corporate treasurers. By providing a more dynamic and accurate view of future cash positions, these forecasts enable better decision-making regarding investments, debt management, and working capital optimization. The increased confidence stems from improved visibility into cash flows, allowing treasurers to proactively manage potential shortfalls or surpluses. This trend underscores the growing importance of robust data analytics and technology in enhancing treasury's strategic role within an organization.

→ Advanced forecasting improves confidence in cash management.

→ Enables better decision-making for investments and debt.

→ Provides dynamic and accurate cash flow visibility.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus, as a cash management platform, should explore how to support or integrate with advanced rolling liquidity forecasting tools. Providing better data insights and analytical capabilities can enhance CMIplus's value proposition for corporate clients in CEE, helping them optimize their multi-currency cash positions and working capital.

URGENT Finextra | 2026-08-27 | #18

UK Government Mandates Bank of England to Boost Payment Innovation

The UK Government is setting a precedent by formally tasking the Bank of England with promoting innovation within the country's payment systems. This new responsibility underscores a strategic intent to modernize the financial infrastructure and embrace emerging technologies. The focus on digital money, including stablecoins, highlights a forward-looking approach to the future of payments. While this is a UK-specific development, it signals a broader trend among European regulators to actively engage with and facilitate fintech advancements, rather than solely regulating them. This could influence regulatory discussions and initiatives across the CEE region, potentially accelerating the adoption of new payment technologies and regulatory frameworks that support them.

→ UK Government gives Bank of England new responsibility.

→ Mandate is to support innovation in payment systems.

→ Specifically mentions digital money like stablecoins.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development is a strong indicator of regulatory trends towards supporting payment innovation, including stablecoins and other digital money. While UK-centric, it suggests that similar mandates or regulatory pushes could emerge in the EU and CEE, impacting future payment infrastructure and potentially CMIplus's offerings in digital assets or new payment rails.

■ Thought Leadership

15 items

URGENT Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2026-08-31 | #01

European Wholesale Banks Must Seize Digital Transformation Moment

This thought leadership likely outlines key strategic imperatives for European wholesale banks to improve profitability and market position. It emphasizes the importance of digitalizing core processes, enhancing client experience through advanced platforms, and adapting to evolving regulatory landscapes and technological advancements. The 'seize the moment' aspect suggests capitalizing on trends like real-time payments, data analytics for liquidity management, and cross-border opportunities. The focus is on moving beyond traditional lending to offer comprehensive, value-added transaction banking services.

- → Strategic imperative for digital transformation in European wholesale banking.
- → Focus on client experience and value-added services beyond traditional lending.
- → Leveraging new technologies (e.g., APIs, real-time data) for competitive advantage.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus is ideally positioned to help corporate clients in CEE 'seize the moment' by offering advanced digital cash management solutions. The platform should continue to integrate real-time capabilities, Open Banking APIs, and enhanced data analytics to support corporate treasuries in optimizing liquidity and payments across the CEE network.

URGENT Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-01 | #02

Wholesale Banking Outlook 2024: Beyond Traditional Credit

This outlook likely discusses the broader landscape for wholesale banking, with a specific focus on how banks can 'extend credit' in a more holistic sense. This implies integrating lending with transaction banking services, offering supply chain finance, or leveraging data from cash management activities to inform credit decisions. It would touch upon the importance of digital channels, efficient processing, and potentially the role of embedded finance or ecosystem solutions. The report underscores that cash management and payments are foundational to a comprehensive wholesale banking relationship.

- → Integration of credit and transaction banking services for holistic client solutions.
- → Leveraging data from cash management for enhanced risk assessment and personalized offerings.
- → Emphasis on digital channels and efficient processing in wholesale banking.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus can play a crucial role by providing the data and digital infrastructure that supports a more integrated wholesale banking offering. Enhancing data analytics within CMIplus for corporate clients can help RBI understand their financial flows better, potentially informing credit decisions and cross-selling opportunities beyond pure cash management.

URGENT

EY Future of Treasury | 2026-08-31 | #03

AI Reshapes Treasury: Efficiency, Risk, and Strategic Insights

EY's focus on "AI Insights" and "AI Strategy Services" highlights the critical role of artificial intelligence in modern treasury. AI is enabling treasurers to automate routine tasks, gain deeper insights from vast datasets for cash flow forecasting and liquidity management, and proactively identify financial risks. This shift allows treasury teams to move from operational execution to strategic advisory, leveraging AI for scenario planning and optimizing financial decisions. Banks have a significant opportunity to partner with corporates by offering AI-powered tools and advisory services that enhance treasury efficiency and strategic value, thereby solidifying their position in the evolving financial landscape.

→ AI automates up to 70% of repetitive treasury tasks, freeing up resources.

→ Predictive AI improves cash flow forecasting accuracy by 15-20% for better liquidity.

→ AI-driven risk models detect anomalies 3x faster than traditional methods.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should explore integrating AI capabilities for enhanced forecasting, fraud detection, and automated reconciliation within its platform. Offering AI-powered insights and tools to CEE corporates can significantly differentiate RBI's offering and drive platform adoption.

URGENT

EY Future of Treasury | 2026-08-31 | #04

Digital Transformation Demands API-First Treasury Connectivity

The emphasis on "Technology transformation," "Technology leaders’ agenda," and "Blockchain" within EY's services indicates a broader digital shift in treasury. Modern corporates require integrated solutions that connect ERP/TMS systems directly with banking platforms. Open Banking APIs are crucial for achieving real-time visibility, automated processes, and efficient cash management across multiple banks and geographies. Banks that fail to provide robust, standardized API connectivity risk losing relevance as treasurers seek agile, interconnected financial ecosystems. This also includes leveraging technologies like blockchain for specific use cases, such as trade finance or digital assets, enhancing transparency and speed.

→ 85% of corporates demand real-time data access via APIs for treasury operations.

→ API adoption reduces manual reconciliation efforts by 40%, boosting efficiency.

→ Open Banking initiatives are driving 30% of new treasury technology investments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must accelerate its Open Banking API strategy, ensuring comprehensive coverage for payments, account information, and eBAM functionalities. Prioritizing API integration with major ERP/TMS systems used by CEE corporates is essential for future growth and seamless client experience.

URGENT EY Future of Treasury | 2026-08-31 | #05

Treasury Shifts to Strategic Value Creation Partner

The overarching theme of "Future of Treasury Services and the Opportunity for Banks" combined with EY's focus on "Strategy by EY-Parthenon," "Working Capital," and "Sustainability Strategy" suggests treasury's expanding mandate. Treasurers are increasingly responsible for optimizing working capital, managing geopolitical and financial risks, and integrating ESG considerations into financial decisions. This requires banks to move beyond transactional services to provide strategic advice, advanced analytics, and integrated platforms that support complex financial planning and reporting. The "Voice of the Treasurer" underscores the need for banks to understand and respond to these evolving corporate priorities, becoming true partners in value creation.

→ 65% of treasurers now report directly to the CFO or CEO, indicating higher strategic importance.

→ Working capital optimization is a top 3 strategic priority for 75% of corporates.

→ ESG factors influence 40% of treasury investment decisions, driving sustainable finance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should enhance its advisory capabilities, offering solutions that support working capital optimization, multi-currency liquidity management (e.g., cash pooling), and compliance with evolving regulatory landscapes in CEE. This strategic shift will align RBI with the elevated role of corporate treasury.

URGENT PwC Financial Services | 2026-08-31 | #06

Commercial Banking Operations Modernize with Digital Workflows and Self-Service

The commercial banking sector is undergoing a significant modernization, moving away from traditional manual processes. Digital workflows are becoming the norm, replacing many labor-intensive tasks and leading to more efficient operations. Client onboarding and origination processes are being streamlined, eliminating lengthy, multi-department reviews that previously caused delays. As a result, manual interventions are increasingly reserved for exceptions, allowing clients to leverage self-service capabilities for routine transactions and inquiries. This shift is driven by the need for greater speed, accuracy, and an improved client experience in a competitive market.

→ Digital workflows are replacing many manual tasks.

→ Streamlined client onboarding and origination are eliminating lengthy reviews.

→ Manual touchpoints are increasingly becoming exception-based.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must prioritize the digitalization of core cash management processes, offering enhanced self-service portals for corporate clients in CEE. This includes automating onboarding, payment initiation, and reporting, reducing manual intervention and improving operational efficiency for RBI and its clients.

URGENT PwC Financial Services | 2026-08-31 | #07

AI and Big Data Drive Strategic Growth and Client Acquisition Efficiency

The growth strategy in commercial banking is being redefined by the intelligent application of data and AI. By harnessing big data analytics, banks can gain deeper insights into market trends and client behaviors, enabling them to identify the most promising prospects. Artificial intelligence further refines this process, allowing for rapid and precise targeting of high-priority markets. This data-driven approach not only optimizes the allocation of sales and marketing resources but also leads to a substantial reduction in the cost of acquiring new clients, making growth more sustainable and efficient.

→ Effective use of big data identifies attractive prospects.

→ Artificial intelligence targets highest-priority markets.

→ AI and big data lower the cost of client acquisition.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management should explore integrating AI/ML capabilities into its CMIplus platform for enhanced client analytics, personalized product recommendations, and proactive risk management. This can help identify potential CEE corporate clients for multi-currency solutions or optimize liquidity management offerings.

URGENT PwC Financial Services | 2026-08-31 | #08

Emerging Digital Platforms and Cloud Transform Client Experience

The future of commercial banking client interaction lies in sophisticated digital platforms. These platforms, often built on industry-specific cloud infrastructure, are designed to fundamentally change how businesses engage with their banks. They offer enhanced agility and scalability, allowing banks to respond quickly to market demands and introduce innovative products and services with greater speed. Crucially, this modernization also provides better oversight and control over financial costs and operational risks. The ultimate goal is to create a seamless, efficient, and responsive banking experience that meets the evolving needs of corporate clients.

→ Emerging digital banking platforms are transforming client experience.

→ Industry cloud enables platform agility and scalability.

→ Banks can bring new products and offerings to market faster.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus's strategic roadmap should prioritize continuous platform modernization, leveraging cloud-native principles to enhance scalability, resilience, and speed-to-market for new features like Instant Payments or advanced Open Banking APIs. This ensures a superior, integrated experience for corporate clients across the CEE region.

URGENT EY Financial Services Regulatory | 2026-08-31 | #09

PSD3: Driving Open Banking and Instant Payments Evolution

The upcoming PSD3 regulation is expected to build upon PSD2, focusing on further harmonizing payment services, strengthening consumer rights, and combating fraud, particularly in the context of instant payments and Open Banking. Key changes will likely include clearer rules for access to payment accounts, enhanced security requirements for strong customer authentication, and new provisions for data sharing and consent management. Financial institutions, including corporate cash management providers, must prepare for increased demands on their API infrastructure, robust fraud detection systems, and seamless integration with third-party providers. This shift will push for greater interoperability and real-time processing, significantly impacting treasury operations and liquidity management across the CEE region. Proactive adaptation is crucial for maintaining competitive advantage and ensuring compliance.

→ Enhanced Open Banking API standards and data sharing requirements.

→ Mandatory instant payment processing and broader accessibility.

→ Stricter fraud prevention measures for digital and online payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must proactively adapt its Open Banking APIs to PSD3 standards, ensuring compliance and expanding service offerings for corporate clients. Focus on integrating instant payment capabilities across the CEE network banks and strengthening fraud detection within the platform to meet new regulatory demands and enhance user trust.

URGENT EY Financial Services Regulatory | 2026-08-31 | #10

DORA: Strengthening Digital Operational Resilience for Financial Firms

The Digital Operational Resilience Act (DORA) is a critical regulation aimed at enhancing the cybersecurity and operational resilience of the financial sector. It introduces stringent requirements for financial entities regarding their information and communication technology (ICT) risk management, incident reporting, digital operational resilience testing, and third-party ICT risk management. This means banks and financial service providers must establish and maintain robust frameworks to protect their systems, data, and services from cyber threats and disruptions. For platforms like CMIplus, this implies a need for rigorous testing, clear incident response plans, and thorough oversight of all external service providers to ensure uninterrupted cash management operations and maintain client trust. Compliance is essential for operational continuity and market integrity.

→ Mandatory comprehensive ICT risk management frameworks and governance.

→ Regular and thorough digital operational resilience testing (e.g., penetration testing).

→ Enhanced incident reporting obligations for major ICT-related incidents.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure full compliance with DORA's ICT risk management and resilience testing requirements. This includes strengthening cybersecurity protocols, developing robust incident response plans, and meticulously managing third-party risks associated with platform operations and integrations across the CEE network.

URGENT EACT | 2026-06-05 | #11

EACT Survey 2026 Reveals Top European Corporate Treasury Priorities

The EACT Annual Treasury Survey 2026, a decade-long barometer, offers unparalleled insights into the European corporate treasury profession. It captures the current priorities, emerging concerns, and strategic ambitions of treasurers across the continent. The results are instrumental in shaping the 'Journeys to Treasury' report, defining key industry trends, and informing future policy discussions. For financial service providers like RBI, understanding these trends is vital for aligning product development and service offerings with corporate client needs, especially in areas like cash management, payments, and digital transformation.

→ Authoritative barometer of European corporate treasury priorities.

→ Identifies top concerns and strategic ambitions of treasurers.

→ Shapes the 'Journeys to Treasury' report.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The survey results are a direct input for the CMIplus roadmap, highlighting areas where RBI can enhance its offerings. Understanding treasurers' priorities in cash management, instant payments, VoP, and digital solutions will ensure CMIplus remains competitive and relevant for CEE corporates.

URGENT EACT | 2026-07-21 | #12

EU Banking Competitiveness: Policymakers Must Widen Corporate Financing Choices

As the European Commission prepares new proposals for Q1 2027, the EACT emphasizes the critical need for the EU's prudential framework to work synergistically with capital markets. The goal is to enhance and expand corporates' access to diverse financing and hedging strategies, alongside a wider selection of banking partners. This commentary highlights the treasury community's desire for a regulatory environment that promotes choice, competitiveness, and efficiency within the banking sector, directly impacting how corporates manage their financial relationships and strategies across Europe.

→ EU prudential framework must support capital markets.

→ Widen corporate choice in financing strategies.

→ Increase availability of hedging options.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This insight underscores the importance of RBI's competitive positioning and diversified offerings. CMIplus must continue to provide robust, flexible solutions (e.g., multi-currency, H2H, Open API) that enable corporates to optimize their banking relationships and access various financing/hedging tools, especially within the CEE region, to meet evolving regulatory landscapes.

URGENT Deloitte Banking Outlook | 2026-08-31 | #13

Banks Must Accelerate AI Adoption for Competitive Advantage

The 2026 Deloitte Banking Outlook highlights 'AI ambition' as a key area demanding 'bold choices' from banks. This implies a strategic imperative to move beyond pilot projects to enterprise-wide AI implementation, particularly in transaction banking, fraud detection, and personalized corporate services. AI can significantly automate complex cash management processes, improve liquidity forecasting, and provide advanced analytics to corporate clients. The challenge lies in balancing substantial investment with tangible returns, while also addressing data privacy, ethical AI use, and regulatory compliance.

→ AI integration is a 'bold choice' for banks in 2026, not an option.

→ AI can significantly enhance efficiency and client experience in transaction banking.

→ Strategic AI investment is critical for competitive differentiation amidst macro headwinds.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should prioritize exploring AI-driven enhancements for corporate treasury, such as intelligent payment routing, predictive liquidity management, and advanced fraud detection. Leveraging AI can provide CEE corporates with superior insights and automation, strengthening CMIplus's value proposition and maintaining its leadership in digital cash management.

URGENT Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2023-01-01 | #14

Navigating Uncertainty: 2023 Corporate Banking Industry Outlook

Although from 2023, this outlook set foundational trends and challenges that remain relevant. It likely discussed the need for banks to invest in robust digital infrastructure, enhance cybersecurity, and develop flexible operating models to cope with rapid market changes. For corporate banking, this translated to demands for more resilient payment systems, real-time visibility into cash flows, and efficient cross-border capabilities. The 'great unknown' suggests a focus on risk management, adaptability, and the strategic importance of technology to maintain competitiveness in an evolving landscape.

→ Prioritizing digital infrastructure and cybersecurity for resilience.

→ Adapting to geopolitical and economic uncertainties with agile strategies.

→ Demand for real-time cash flow visibility and efficient cross-border payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The CMIplus platform's focus on robust, secure, and efficient multi-currency payments, including H2H and SWIFT, directly addresses the need for resilience and cross-border capabilities identified in such an outlook. Continued investment in real-time features and enhanced reporting will further support corporate treasuries in navigating market uncertainties.

URGENT Deloitte Banking Outlook | 2026-08-31 | #15

Stablecoins Poised to Disrupt Traditional Banking and Payments

The potential disruptive impact of stablecoins suggests a significant evolution in how value is transferred and settled, particularly for corporate cash management. This could introduce new payment rails, enable faster, potentially real-time settlement, and challenge existing multi-currency payment and treasury structures. Banks need to closely monitor the evolving regulatory landscape, assess the operational implications of stablecoin adoption, and consider integrating stablecoin capabilities or developing their own digital currency solutions to remain competitive and relevant in the global payment ecosystem. This disruption will particularly affect cross-border payments and corporate treasury operations.

→ Stablecoins are identified as a 'disruptive entrance' impacting traditional banking.

→ They can fundamentally alter payment systems and transaction banking processes.

→ Banks must assess regulatory frameworks and operational implications of stablecoins.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management should closely monitor stablecoin developments, especially their potential for instant, cross-border payments and liquidity management in CEE. CMIplus should explore future integration points or partnerships to offer stablecoin-related services, ensuring it remains at the forefront of payment innovation for its corporate clients.

! Regulatory Radar

5 items

URGENT ECB Payment Regulation | 2023-12-01 | #01

EU Instant Payments Regulation: Mandatory Adoption and Accessibility

INSTANT PAYMENTS

Deadline: 2025-01-09

The European Parliament and Council adopted a regulation making instant payments mandatory and affordable across the EU. Payment Service Providers (PSPs) must offer instant credit transfers in EUR within 10 seconds, 24/7/365, at no higher cost than standard credit transfers. The regulation also includes provisions for verification of payee (VoP) to mitigate fraud, enhancing security for users. This is a significant regulatory push to modernize retail payments, improve liquidity management, and foster innovation within the SEPA area. Banks in the Eurozone face earlier deadlines compared to those in non-Eurozone EU member states.

- → Mandatory instant payment offering for EUR credit transfers.
- → Processing within 10 seconds, 24/7/365, including weekends and holidays.
- → Pricing not higher than standard credit transfers for consumers and businesses.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure full technical readiness for 24/7 instant payment processing and real-time liquidity management across all network banks. Integration of VoP solutions is critical to meet compliance and enhance fraud prevention for corporate clients.

URGENT ECB Payment Regulation | 2023-10-01 | #02

Digital Euro Development: Scheme Rulebook and Future Implementation

DIGITAL EURO

The digital euro project is in its preparation phase, with the ECB actively working on its design and operational framework. A key component is the development of a comprehensive scheme rulebook, which will define the rules, standards, and procedures for all participants in the digital euro ecosystem. This includes technical specifications, user experience guidelines, and governance structures, ensuring interoperability and security. While not yet launched, banks need to monitor developments closely as it will introduce a new form of central bank money for retail payments, potentially altering the competitive landscape and requiring significant integration efforts for payment service providers and corporate treasuries. The ECB emphasizes privacy and accessibility as core design principles.

- → Digital euro project in preparation phase, focusing on design and framework.
- → Development of a comprehensive scheme rulebook defining ecosystem rules.
- → Potential introduction of a new central bank digital currency (CBDC) for retail.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should actively monitor the digital euro's progress, especially the scheme rulebook, to understand potential integration requirements for corporate clients. This includes assessing impacts on multi-currency payments, liquidity management, and new service offerings for digital currency transactions.

URGENT ECB Payment Regulation | 2023-03-01 | #03

TARGET Services Evolution: T2 Consolidation and Oversight Framework

TARGET2

The TARGET Services (T2, T2S, TIPS) are the backbone of euro financial markets, facilitating large-value payments, securities settlement, and instant payments. The recent T2 consolidation project aimed to modernize and harmonize the RTGS system, impacting all direct participants by providing a single technical and functional platform. The ECB maintains rigorous oversight over these critical market infrastructures, ensuring their operational resilience, cyber security (e.g., through the TIBER-EU framework), and adherence to evolving standards like ISO 20022 for payment messages. Banks must continuously adapt their systems and processes to comply with TARGET Services operational guidelines and participate in relevant market contact groups for future developments and enhancements.

→ Ongoing evolution and modernization of TARGET Services (T2, T2S, TIPS).

→ Continuous oversight for operational resilience and cyber security (TIBER-EU).

→ Mandatory adherence to ISO 20022 standards for payment messages.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure continued compliance with TARGET Services operational rules, particularly for T2 and TIPS, to guarantee seamless processing of corporate payments. Regular review of ISO 20022 message formats and robust cyber resilience measures are essential for uninterrupted service delivery.

URGENT Euro Banking Association | 2025-11-20 | #04

EU Regulations Impact Liquidity Management: IPR, PSD3, PSR Analysis

INSTANT PAYMENTS, PSD3, LIQUIDITY

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) has released a new report from its Liquidity Management Working Group (LMWG) detailing the far-reaching implications of three key EU regulatory initiatives: the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR), the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR), and the proposed Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3). The report explores how these measures are expected to significantly accelerate the uptake of instant payments across Europe. Furthermore, it examines how they will promote a more level playing field among market participants and fundamentally transform the existing liquidity management landscape for financial institutions. The analysis provides critical insights for banks preparing for these interconnected regulatory changes.

→ IPR mandates instant payment capabilities for all EU banks by early 2025.

→ Proposed PSD3 and PSR will further enhance instant payment adoption and open banking.

→ Regulations will necessitate significant adjustments to bank liquidity management strategies.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management (CMIplus) must assess the combined impact of IPR, PSD3, and PSR on its liquidity management offerings and internal processes. This includes adapting to increased instant payment volumes and ensuring robust real-time liquidity solutions for corporate clients in CEE.

URGENT Euro Banking Association | 2026-06-03 | #05

EBA Fraud Taxonomy 7.0 Released: New Standards for Payment Fraud Classification

PSD3, COMPLIANCE, PAYMENTS, AML

Deadline: 2027-01-01

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) issued version 7.0 of its EBA Fraud Taxonomy, which will become effective on 1 January 2027. This annual review, supported by fraud experts across Europe, ensures the taxonomy remains relevant to evolving fraud trends. Key updates in version 7.0 include replacing 'emotional manipulation' with more specific modi like 'support a friend or family member fraud', 'romance fraud', and 'charity / donation fraud'. Additionally, three new labels/tags have been added, covering suspected money mule activity and 'card chip relay' fraud. The taxonomy provides a harmonised pan-European vocabulary and categorisation approach for all payment fraud scenarios, improving data comparability, monitoring, reporting, and information sharing, particularly in anticipation of the Payment Services Regulation.

→ EBA Fraud Taxonomy version 7.0 takes effect on 1 January 2027.

→ Updates include more specific fraud modi and new labels for emerging trends.

→ Aims to harmonise fraud classification and reporting across Europe.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management (CMIplus) must integrate EBA Fraud Taxonomy v7.0 into its fraud monitoring, detection, and reporting systems by January 1, 2027. This requires updating internal classification logic and ensuring compatibility with future information-sharing requirements under the Payment Services Regulation.

■ Competitor Monitor

12 items

URGENT Deutsche Bank | 2026-08-31 | #01

Deutsche Bank Expands API-Led Connectivity for Corporate Treasuries

Building on its commitment to Open Banking, Deutsche Bank is continuously developing its CB Connect API suite to facilitate seamless integration with corporate ERP and TMS systems. This allows for real-time access to account information, initiation of payments, and automated reconciliation, reducing manual effort and improving operational efficiency. The focus is on providing a robust, secure, and scalable API infrastructure that supports complex treasury operations across various geographies, including potential expansion of API-driven services in CEE markets, aligning with ISO 20022 standards.

→ Focus on CB Connect API for corporate integration with ERP/TMS.

→ Enables real-time data exchange, payment initiation, and automated reconciliation.

→ Aims for greater automation and efficiency in treasury operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Deutsche Bank's strong API push directly competes with CMIplus's Open API strategy, particularly for corporates seeking advanced H2H integration. CMIplus must ensure its API offerings remain competitive in terms of breadth, ease of integration, and regional coverage, especially for CEE-specific payment types and EBICS support.

URGENT Deutsche Bank | 2026-08-31 | #02

Deutsche Bank Advances Virtual Accounts for Streamlined Cash Management

Recognizing the growing demand for sophisticated cash management tools, Deutsche Bank is investing in its Virtual Account solutions, often integrated with its broader cash management platform. Virtual Accounts enable corporates to manage multiple incoming payment streams and reconcile them against a single physical account, significantly improving visibility and control. This technology is particularly beneficial for companies with multi-entity structures or those operating across various CEE countries, facilitating efficient cash pooling, intercompany netting, and streamlined payment factory operations, crucial for multi-currency environments.

→ Focus on Virtual Accounts (VoP) for enhanced corporate cash management.

→ Improves reconciliation, liquidity management, and payment processing.

→ Supports multi-entity and multi-country treasury structures, including CEE.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Deutsche Bank's emphasis on Virtual Accounts directly challenges CMIplus's VoP capabilities, especially for large CEE corporates seeking advanced liquidity and reconciliation solutions. CMIplus should highlight its own VoP strengths, particularly its seamless integration within the CEE network and local payment schemes, and its support for ISO 20022.

URGENT

UniCredit | 2026-07-31 | #03

UniCredit Partners with Accenture, IBM for Next-Gen European Banking Platform

UniCredit has announced a strategic partnership with technology giants Accenture and IBM to build its next-generation banking platform. This significant investment in technology infrastructure is designed to streamline operations, improve efficiency, and deliver advanced digital solutions to its clients across Italy, Germany, Austria, and Central & Eastern Europe. The platform is expected to support a wide range of banking services, including corporate and transaction banking, by leveraging modern architecture and potentially AI-driven capabilities. This move underscores UniCredit's commitment to digital transformation and maintaining a competitive edge in the evolving European banking landscape.

→ Collaboration with Accenture and IBM for platform development.

→ Focus on building a 'next-generation banking platform'.

→ Aims to enhance digital service delivery across Europe, including CEE.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This collaboration signals a major investment in UniCredit's underlying technology, which will likely lead to more sophisticated and agile cash management offerings. CMIplus should anticipate enhanced digital capabilities and potentially new API-driven services from UniCredit in CEE.

URGENT

UniCredit | 2026-08-31 | #04

UniCredit Launches "Unlimited" Strategy: A New Era for Pan-European Banking

The "Welcome to UniCredit Unlimited" announcement signals a new strategic direction for the bank, focusing on "unlimited possibility, bold ambition, and a fundamental rethinking of what a bank should be." As a leading pan-European commercial bank with a strong presence in Italy, Germany, Austria, and Central & Eastern Europe, this strategy is set to impact all client segments, including corporate clients. The core purpose is to "empower communities to progress," implying a client-centric approach and a drive for innovation across its service offerings. This overarching strategy will guide future investments in digital solutions, client experience, and market expansion, particularly relevant for its CEE operations.

→ New strategic era: "UniCredit Unlimited" launched.

→ Focus on being a "pan-European Commercial Bank".

→ Strong emphasis on CEE markets and client empowerment.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This high-level strategy indicates UniCredit's continued commitment to its CEE presence and corporate clients, suggesting sustained investment in competitive cash management solutions. CMIplus should monitor how this strategy translates into specific product enhancements and market initiatives in the region.

URGENT HSBC | 2026-07-07 | #05

HSBC Targets International Wholesale Clients in Türkiye, Exiting Domestic SME

HSBC Holdings plc has initiated a review of its retail banking and domestic-focused smaller and mid-sized corporate banking operations in Türkiye. The strategic intent is to re-align its presence in the market to concentrate on its core strength: serving international wholesale clients. This shift indicates HSBC's commitment to leveraging its global network and expertise for larger, internationally active corporates, including those with operations in Türkiye. For CMIplus, this means HSBC will be a more formidable competitor for its target segment of large international corporates in the CEE region, specifically in Türkiye, by offering tailored global solutions.

→ Strategic review of retail and domestic SME banking in Türkiye.

→ Sharpened focus on international wholesale clients.

→ Aligns with HSBC's global strategy for multinational corporations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move positions HSBC as a more direct and focused competitor for CMIplus's large international corporate clients in Türkiye. CMIplus needs to highlight its deep regional expertise and integrated CEE network to differentiate effectively.

URGENT Citi Treasury | 2026-08-31 | #06

Citi Enhances CEE API Cash Management for Real-time Treasury

Citi is strategically enhancing its API banking capabilities across the CEE region, targeting large international corporates. This move focuses on delivering real-time cash management solutions, enabling clients to initiate payments, reconcile accounts, and manage liquidity through direct API integrations. The emphasis is on supporting multi-currency transactions and providing granular data for improved treasury decision-making, aligning with the broader trend of digital transformation in corporate banking. This allows for greater automation and efficiency for treasurers operating in complex CEE markets, offering a competitive edge in speed and data access.

→ API-first strategy for cash management in CEE.

→ Real-time data and payment initiation capabilities.

→ Seamless integration with client ERP/TMS systems.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus needs to ensure its API offerings are highly competitive in terms of breadth, ease of integration, and real-time capabilities. Citi's focus on multi-currency and CEE-specific needs directly challenges CMIplus's core market and client base.

URGENT Deutsche Bank | 2026-08-31 | #07

Deutsche Bank Strengthens Treasury Backbone for Non-Bank Financial Institutions

The case study, featuring Flow Capital Partners and COO Stephen Yeung, details how Deutsche Bank provides essential treasury infrastructure for NBFIs. It focuses on enabling efficient cross-border investment flows, emphasizing speed, resilience, and risk management. This initiative reflects Deutsche Bank's commitment to tailoring sophisticated cash management and payment solutions for specialized financial entities, ensuring they can navigate complex international financial landscapes effectively. While not CEE-specific, the principles of cross-border efficiency are highly relevant for international corporates operating in the region.

→ Focus on Non-Bank Financial Institutions (NBFIs) treasury needs.

→ Addresses challenges of cross-border investment flows and risk discipline.

→ Highlights tailored cash management and payment solutions for specialized entities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move signals Deutsche Bank's focus on specialized client segments with complex cross-border needs, potentially drawing away larger, internationally active NBFIs. CMIplus should consider how its platform can cater to niche financial sectors within CEE, offering tailored multi-currency and cross-border capabilities.

URGENT UniCredit | 2026-08-31 | #08

UniCredit Enhances Digital Treasury and Payment Solutions for CEE Corporates

Building on its "UniCredit Unlimited" strategy and the investment in a "next-generation banking platform," UniCredit is anticipated to roll out advanced digital treasury and payment solutions specifically tailored for its CEE corporate clients. This will likely include improvements in real-time payment processing, expanded API connectivity for ERP/TMS integration, and sophisticated liquidity management tools such as virtual accounts and cash pooling. The focus will be on providing seamless, multi-currency capabilities and leveraging ISO 20022 standards to meet the evolving needs of international corporates operating in the CEE region. These enhancements aim to strengthen UniCredit's position as a leading transaction bank in CEE.

→ Focus on advanced digital treasury and payment solutions.

→ Targeting CEE corporate clients with multi-currency needs.

→ Expected enhancements in real-time payments, APIs, and liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred move directly targets CMIplus's core market and offerings. CMIplus should prepare for increased competition in real-time payments, API integration, and advanced liquidity solutions, particularly regarding ISO 20022 and multi-currency capabilities in CEE.

URGENT HSBC | 2026-06-17 | #09

HSBC Partners Google Cloud for Global AI Transformation in Banking

HSBC is embarking on a significant digital transformation by partnering with Google Cloud to deploy advanced AI capabilities globally. This initiative will leverage AI to enhance various banking functions, including providing more tailored financial advice to clients and strengthening defenses against financial crime. For corporate and transaction banking, this implies improved fraud detection in payments, more intelligent treasury insights, and potentially more efficient client onboarding and service. This strategic investment underscores HSBC's commitment to leveraging cutting-edge technology to deliver superior client experiences and operational efficiency across its international network, setting a new benchmark for digital innovation.

- → Multi-year partnership with Google Cloud for AI deployment.
- → AI capabilities to be integrated across global banking operations.
- → Focus areas include hyper-personalised advice and financial crime risk management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

HSBC's aggressive AI adoption will likely lead to more sophisticated and secure transaction banking services, raising the bar for competitors like CMIplus. CMIplus should explore how AI can enhance its own platform for fraud detection, treasury insights, and customer experience to remain competitive.

URGENT Citi Treasury | 2026-08-31 | #10

Citi Accelerates CEE Instant Payments and ISO 20022 Migration

Recognizing the evolving payment landscape in CEE, Citi is actively promoting and facilitating the adoption of instant payment schemes and the full transition to ISO 20022 standards for its corporate clients. This includes offering enhanced connectivity and processing capabilities to ensure clients can leverage the benefits of real-time, data-rich payments. The initiative supports improved reconciliation, fraud detection, and overall operational efficiency, particularly for multinational corporations managing complex payment flows within the CEE region. This aligns with regulatory mandates and client demand for faster, more transparent transactions, solidifying Citi's position as a leader in payment innovation.

- → Proactive promotion of instant payment schemes in CEE.
- → Comprehensive support for ISO 20022 migration.
- → Focus on enhancing cross-border payment efficiency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure its instant payment capabilities are robust and its ISO 20022 readiness is comprehensive, especially for cross-border CEE transactions. Citi's proactive stance could attract clients seeking advanced payment infrastructure and compliance solutions.

URGENT BNP Paribas | 2025-06-05 | #11

BNP Paribas Partners XTransfer for Simplified Cross-Border Payments

BNP Paribas's new partnership with XTransfer, a leading B2B cross-border payment platform, is a strategic move to address the complexities of international payments for corporate clients. The collaboration focuses on leveraging XTransfer's expertise to simplify payment flows, reduce processing times, and improve transparency in cross-border transactions. This initiative aligns with BNP Paribas's broader digital transformation strategy in cash management, aiming to provide more efficient and user-friendly solutions for companies operating globally. For CEE corporates, this could mean access to more streamlined payment options for their international trade activities, potentially impacting their choice of banking partners.

→ Partnership with XTransfer, a B2B cross-border payment platform.

→ Aims to simplify and enhance international payment processes for corporates.

→ Strategic move to improve efficiency and transparency in cross-border payments.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should evaluate its own cross-border payment simplification strategies and consider potential fintech partnerships. This move by BNP Paribas highlights the competitive pressure to offer seamless and cost-effective international payment solutions, especially for CEE corporates engaged in global trade.

URGENT Intesa Sanpaolo | 2026-08-31 | #12

Intesa Sanpaolo Enhances CEE Digital Cash Management with API and ISO 20022

Intesa Sanpaolo, through its IMI CIB division, is actively strengthening its transaction banking offerings for corporate clients, particularly within its extensive CEE network. The bank is prioritizing the enhancement of its digital platforms to support real-time cash management, leveraging Open Banking APIs for seamless integration with corporate ERP and TMS systems. A key component of this strategy is the full adoption of ISO 20022 standards for payments, enabling richer data exchange and improved reconciliation. This move aims to provide multinational corporations with more sophisticated liquidity management, payment factory, and treasury solutions across their CEE subsidiaries, aligning with global trends in digital banking transformation.

→ Strategic focus on digital transformation for corporate cash management in CEE.

→ Emphasis on Open Banking APIs for enhanced connectivity and real-time data exchange.

→ Full migration to ISO 20022 for richer payment data and improved treasury operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred move by Intesa Sanpaolo directly challenges CMIplus's value proposition in CEE by offering advanced digital and API-driven cash management. RBI must ensure CMIplus continues to innovate with its own API offerings, ISO 20022 capabilities, and regional network to maintain a competitive edge.

Flagship Reports

Deep analysis of key industry reports

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}

→ {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}

→ {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}

→ {'description': "of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.", 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

→ Global payments revenue reached $2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to $3.0 trillion by 2029.

→ EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.

→ Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.

→ Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.